Knowledge Transfer Partnerships

KTP BENEFITS

Knowledge Transfer Partnerships are designed to benefit everyone involved

- Businesses will acquire new knowledge and expertise
- KTP Associates will gain business-based experience and personal and professional development opportunities
- Universities, colleges or research organisations will bring their experience to enhance the business relevance of their research and teaching

Knowledge Transfer Partnerships
Accelerating business innovation;
a Technology Strategy Board programme

http://www.ktponline.org.uk

COPYRITE BUSINESS SOLUTIONS LTD
KTP HELPS GROW SOFTWARE SKILLS AND BUSINESS SYSTEMS TO EXPLOIT NEW MARKETS

ABOUT THIS CASE STUDY

This Knowledge Transfer Partnership (KTP) project brought together Copyrite Business Solutions Ltd and the University of Bournemouth in a successful collaboration. The aim was to implement business integration and workflow management procedures internally, and extend electronic document management systems by building upon enabling technologies (which can also be provided to customers).

ABOUT THE SPONSOR

The **Technology Strategy Board** is a business-led organisation established by the Government. Its mission is to accelerate research into, and development and exploitation of, technology and innovation for the benefit of UK business – building economic growth and quality of life.

FAST FACTS

- Culture change embedded to embrace IT solutions
- New software and applications provide greater access to business data
- A new product that can be changed and refined to exploit new markets
- Annual sales turnover is expected to rise by over £150,000
- The KTP has brought experience and career development for the Associate
- New opportunities and case study material for the University

The Company

"By offering a KTP placement we have been able to access the software and business expertise of not only the Associate but the University team behind him."

Ian Stewart, Director, Copyrite Business Solutions Ltd

Copyrite Business Solutions Ltd was established in 1993 and is a small to medium-sized enterprise (SME) based in Wimborne, Dorset. The Company is one of the leading suppliers of print, software and IT solutions for UK businesses. It prides itself on providing a complete office service from supplying machinery such as photocopiers, printers, fax machines and scanners to offering software, managed IT services, support and service engineers to customers.



ABOUT THE PROJECT

Copyrite recognised the opportunity for introducing advanced business and IT skills to complement its existing range of services. The Company wanted to use a model-based approach in the design of value-added electronic document management (EDM) software applications. Copyrite identified that it could better respond to customers' requests for business consultancy by implementing best-practice business integration and workflow management procedures. Copyrite also anticipated access to a vast market that would include the majority of UK office-based businesses. The Company looked to Bournemouth University for guidance and support through collaboration.

BENEFITS

This KTP project successfully fulfilled its aim of implementing business integration and workflow management procedures in-house. It was also able to extend its EDM systems by building on enabling technologies that could be used by its customers.

The development of GenuScan was one of the key successes of the project. This is a 'generic connector' that enables documents to be scanned in and transferred to the document control application, running on a PC. This function can be customised to meet user needs and it can be run without specialised hardware or software skills.

The KTP project has ushered in a culture change within Copyrite such that IT solutions are now seen as crucial to the success of its business operations. New skills have been introduced including an improved understanding of document control applications, ways of increasing the visibility of business data and a greater understanding of customer needs. New capabilities have also been acquired, such as new functions to increase sales and access markets, and these will provide a long-term legacy from the KTP. The Company now has the ability to manage, modify and manipulate new products. Copyrite also has the understanding necessary to develop subsequent versions of new products, and these capabilities will help to maintain performance and retain a competitive edge.

As a result of the project, the Company has a higher profile within its existing markets and the confidence and ability to exploit new markets. GenuScan has been rolled out to current and new customers. Already it is estimated that the annual added value of these products and services will be in excess of £150,000. The Company can rely on its new culture, where new IT capabilities are embraced, to provide a healthy competitive advantage. It also has the appropriate systems and procedures to underpin its business operations and support business growth in the future.

RESULTS

- Culture change embedded to embrace IT solutions
- New software and applications to provide greater access to business data
- A new product that can be changed and refined to exploit new markets
- Integrated systems established to enhance workflow management
- Annual sales turnover is expected to rise by over £150,000

The Associate

"I really enjoyed taking on responsibility at the start of my career, it helped me developing my technical and project management skills. It also gave me a sense of achievement."

Salman Abdul, KTP Associate

The Associate needed an understanding of both advanced business and IT skills for this KTP project. He has been praised because his performance and initiative exceeded what was required. He has acquired a good grounding in the work of the Company, its business practices, its customers' needs and the challenges that face an SME. This enabled him to develop the GenuScan product and associated IT solutions. The Associate has increased his knowledge of business development and also associated software and IT skills. He received training in proprietary packages associated with document management and process control. In addition, he has improved his skills and abilities in project management, leadership, teamwork, communication and negotiation. He was offered a position with the Company.

RESULTS

- Improved skills in providing advanced business and IT solutions
- Experience of product development
- Professional development and greater awareness of business realities
- Offer of employment for the Associate by the Company

The Academic Partner

"This project has given us firsthand experience and insight into how a Company operates efficiently, and how best to introduce change in terms of improving business integration and workflow management."

Michael Jones, Lead Academic, School of Design, Engineering & Computing, University of Bournemouth

Bournemouth University

BENEFITS

Being involved in this KTP has provided benefits in a number of key areas. The team have witnessed the practical application of business integration and workflow management, as well as methods for overcoming the difficulties that accompanied the implementation. The University has an on-going rapport with the Company. The experience and insight will inform the University's research in the area of model-based design of architectures for systems integration in particular. In addition, the KTP has enabled the team to see first hand how change management affects an SME. This opportunity has sparked interest in new areas of research and helped to provide useful, relevant information and data. It has also helped the team to derive case study information and new teaching material from live commercial situations.

RESULTS

- Greater practical knowledge of how to transfer knowledge to an SME
- New up-to-date case study examples will benefit teaching
- Opportunities for new research activities
- On-going rapport with the Company